

designed for your fingers. You interact with the software on the screen by touching, tapping, swiping, and performing other multi-touch gestures. Many controls are intuitive: tap the Edit button in Contacts, for example, to edit a person's information. Other motions may not be obvious at first, but quickly become natural.

Tap

The most obvious action is to point at an area of the screen, like a button or other control, and lightly tap with one finger. Sometimes, you'll want to double-tap the screen, such as when you want to zoom in on a section of a Web page in Safari.

Touch and hold

Instead of tapping the screen, there are times when you want to touch the screen and maintain contact to elicit an action.

Drag

Touch and hold a point on the screen, then move your finger across it. Drag a web page in Safari from bottom to top to scroll as you read.

Flick and swipe

A flick (yes, that's Apple's official name for it) is like a drag, but faster. On a web page, touch the screen and flick your finger to "throw" the page in any direction. The software simulates the physics of the motion and slows the scrolling page until it comes to a stop, based on the velocity of the flick. A swipe is similar to a flick, but you drag something (usually horizontally) a bit more slowly. You swipe a photo from right to left to advance to the next picture, for instance.

Pinch

When you want to zoom in or out on an item, such as a map, a photo, or a web page, touch two fingers to the screen and pinch them together (to zoom out) or spread them apart (to zoom in).

Rotate

Press two fingers to the screen and rotate them in a circle to rotate something, such as a photo in the Photos app.